



Shōgun

Tokugawa Ieyasu was given the Japanese title of shōgun, meaning military leader, which marked the start of more than 260 years of Tokugawa Shogunate rule. He set up a second capital in the fishing village of Edo, which later expanded to become Tokyo.

1603

Also on this day

1882 German physician Robert Koch announced his discovery of the bacterium that causes the disease tuberculosis (TB).

1944 Seventy-six Allied pilots escaped from the German Stalag Luft III prisoner-of-war camp through a tunnel dug in secret.

2002 US animated comedy *Shrek*, starring a green ogre, won the first Academy Award for Best Animated Feature.

1989 Major oil spill

When US oil tanker *Exxon Valdez* struck a reef in the Gulf of Alaska, about 37,000 tonnes of oil spilled into the sea. The leaked oil poisoned local wildlife, such as sea birds, otters, and seals, and caused environmental damage to 2,400 km (1,500 miles) of Alaskan coastline.

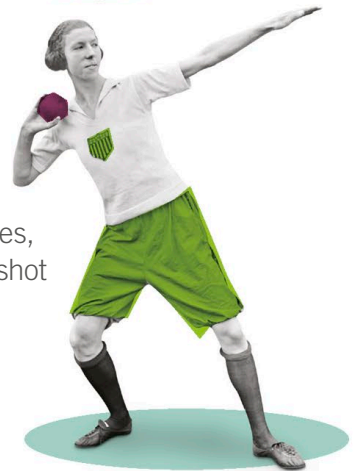
March

24

1921

Women's Olympiad

Monte Carlo, Monaco, hosted the Women's Olympiad – the first international women's sports event. For five days, 100 female athletes, including gold-winning shot putter Lucile Ellerbe Godbold, took part in a variety of track and field competitions.



Born this day

1826 Matilda Joselyn Gage, US activist. She founded the National Woman Suffrage Association and campaigned for social reforms to benefit women and Indigenous Americans.

1874 Harry Houdini, Hungarian-born US illusionist. He became famous for his astonishing disappearing tricks and amazing escape acts.

